

Kyung Pyo (Paul) Kang

Teaching Statement

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Teaching Philosophy

I believe students learn analytical methods more effectively when they understand the problems those methods are designed to solve. My teaching therefore focuses on three principles: connecting methods to concrete problems, understanding how data are generated, and interpreting the practical implications of analytical results.

Connect methods to concrete problems. I learned methods such as difference-in-differences, propensity score matching, and deep metric learning because specific research and industry projects required them. These projects included improving donor contributions in a crowdfunding campaign, verifying wheel-design similarity for an automotive manufacturer, and evaluating the incentive design of a mobile health application. I use the same approach in teaching. Rather than presenting methods as isolated techniques, I connect them to the problems they are designed to address.

Understand how data are generated. My research has involved platform data, corporate datasets, and human-subjects data collected through experiments. These experiences have shown me that analyzing data requires understanding how the data were generated and what they measure. Students should therefore learn not only how to apply an analytical method but also how to evaluate the data used in the analysis. I encourage students to consider what conclusions the data support and what conclusions they do not support.

Connect analysis to decisions. Analytical results become useful when students can interpret their implications for a real decision. I therefore want students to move beyond producing statistical results or model outputs. They should be able to explain what those results mean, how they address the original problem, and what limitations should be considered when using them to make a decision.

Teaching Experience

I have teaching experience in both university courses and applied technical training. At Kyung Hee University, I served as a teaching assistant for Business Analytics from September to December 2022 and Capstone Design from February 2022 to June 2024.

I have also worked as a lecturer through the Elice Coding Platform, a coding-education platform used for corporate and university technical training. Through Elice, I taught working professionals and university students in programs for HMM (Hyundai Merchant Marine Company), Samsung Electronics, industry professionals, Inha University, and HL Company (Halla Holdings).

These experiences exposed me to students with different levels of technical preparation and different learning goals. University courses require students to develop knowledge over a longer period, whereas professional training requires them to apply technical material within a shorter and more focused setting. Teaching in both settings has helped me adapt the presentation of technical material to the background and goals of different audiences.

Future Teaching Interests

My research and technical background prepare me to teach courses in business analytics, data-driven decision making, and applications of AI and machine learning in business. My research focuses on digital platforms, IT healthcare, e-commerce, and agentic AI, and my technical experience includes Python, R, STATA, Django, and AWS.

I am particularly interested in incorporating real data and research problems into my courses. For example, questions involving platform incentives, AI disclosure, and personalization can provide settings in which students apply analytical methods to concrete business problems. These projects can help students learn how to select an appropriate method, evaluate the data available to them, interpret the resulting evidence, and connect that evidence to a decision.

My goal is for students to develop both technical skills and the ability to use those skills appropriately. Students should leave my courses able to understand a problem, determine what the available data can support, select an appropriate analytical approach, and communicate the implications of their analysis.